

Shawn McCarthy Resume

Shawn McCarthy

Shawn McCarthy

Vice President, Architecture and Tech Strategy | Chair, Chief Architect Forum | PhD Candidate, December 2026

Denver, Colorado | smccarthy@iasaoffice.org | [linkedin.com/in/shawnemccarthy](https://www.linkedin.com/in/shawnemccarthy) | chiefarcheologist.com

Professional Summary

Technology strategy and enterprise architecture executive with 20+ years modernizing complex financial services technology portfolios. Leads business, financial, and technology strategy for a global wealth and asset management organization, following six years leading global architecture, application security, and information risk. Known for turning architectural evidence into investment strategy, product operating models, AI-enabled engineering, and platform modernization.

Core Competencies

Enterprise Architecture; AI Governance; Application Security; Information Risk; Technology Strategy; Evidence-Based Practice; BTABoK Stewardship; Professional Body Governance; Product Architecture; DevSecOps; Cloud Platforms; Architecture Governance; Platform Modernization; Talent Development; Financial Services; Application Portfolio Management; Risk Management; API Strategy; API Product Strategy; Developer Experience; Engineering Leadership; NVIDIA DLI; Agentic AI; Generative AI; Generative Deep Learning.

Leadership Impact

- Lead business, financial, and technology strategy for Manulife's Global Wealth & Asset Management organization, spanning technology investment, platform modernization, AI-enabled engineering, innovation, and operating model transformation.
- Chair the Chief Architect Forum board (IASA); led ratification of a renewed mission and five-commitment operating model - cross-practice adoption reporting, structured experimentation, applicability findings including limitations, BTABoK stewardship, and the teaching hospital - establishing tested evidence rather than fashion as the basis for architecture practice.
- Led a 72-person global architecture, application security, and information risk organization supporting approximately 700 applications across North America, Asia, and Europe.
- Transformed fragmented architecture governance into a federated, outcome-driven capability embedded in business strategy, risk management, and delivery execution.
- Recognized as a Forrester 2025 Enterprise Architecture Awards finalist for Project Atlas, an architect development and practice maturity program.
- Evolved portfolio planning from disposition-based application roadmaps to strategic business blueprints across Global Retail, Global Retirement, and Institutional businesses.
- Led a 200-person engineering organization at Vantiv across API products, developer portals, prepaid platforms, secure delivery, and PCI/SOX control environments.

Professional Experience

Vice President, Architecture and Tech Strategy

Manulife Financial Corporation | August 2026 - Present

- Lead business, financial, and technology strategy for Manulife's Global Wealth & Asset Management organization.
- Accountable for architecture, technology investment strategy, platform modernization, AI-enabled engineering, innovation, and operating model transformation.
- Align capital allocation, architecture, agentic engineering, autonomous software delivery, workforce transformation, and governance to turn technology into measurable business value.
- Drive growth, delivery predictability, resiliency, cost optimization, and scalable enterprise performance through disciplined investment decisions and modern engineering practices.

Vice President, Chief Architect, Security Officer

Manulife Financial Corporation | March 2020 - August 2026

- Led enterprise architecture, application security, and information risk capabilities for a global financial services enterprise.
- Owned architecture, risk, and operational/engineering governance for Global Wealth and Asset Management across the US, Canada, Asia, and Europe.
- Built a federated architecture operating model connecting business capability, application portfolio, security risk, governance evidence, and delivery execution.
- Guided modernization strategy across legacy systems, cloud platforms, APIs, AI delivery, and security-left governance.

Managing Director, Platform and Application Architecture

Charles Schwab | September 2016 - March 2020

- Led centralized solution architecture for digital experience, trading, mobile, digital messaging, CI/CD, APIs, cloud, and wealth management platforms.
- Developed technology strategy blueprints and multi-year roadmaps for a 1,200+ application portfolio.
- Established architecture practices for platform strategy, 4+1 architecture views, modernization, and technical debt management.
- Created the N.E.R.D. talent development program to accelerate cross-functional engineering and architecture capability.

Head of Portals and APIs / Director, Application Development

Vantiv | November 2011 - September 2016

- Led a 200-person engineering organization across API solutions, developer portals, prepaid platform delivery, and secure application development.
- Advanced API-as-a-product, developer experience, SOA, ESB, and modern .NET architecture patterns for transaction-processing platforms.
- Directed platform improvements across automation, test automation, monitoring, logging, security frameworks, encryption, data warehousing, reporting, and responsive web strategy.
- Served across application security, agile change, PCI/SOX audit, intern development, and organizational transformation initiatives.

Graduate Instructor and Advisory Board Member

University of Colorado Denver | January 2015 - Present

- Teach graduate-level technology courses covering generative AI, LLM applications, cloud deployment, DevSecOps, APIs, and test automation.
- State-approved continuing education provider for Generative AI Deep Learning Ethics for licensed insurance professionals.

Education and Credentials

PhD Candidate, Computer Science and Information Systems, expected December 2026. University of Colorado Denver, Graduate Instructor. Platinum NVIDIA Deep Learning Institute Instructor. NVIDIA Certified Professional: Agentic AI. Certified across the NVIDIA generative deep learning suite. Chief Architect Forum (IASA), Board Chair.

Board and Professional Leadership

Board Chair

Chief Architect Forum (IASA) | September 2026 - Present | Board Member, November 2024 - September 2026

Led ratification of the Forum's renewed mission and its five-commitment operating model: cross-practice adoption reporting, structured experimentation, applicability findings including limitations, BTABoK stewardship, and the teaching hospital. Established the Forum alongside the Applied AI and Sustainability communities, served by a shared foundation capacity spanning evidence, experiment protocols, BTABoK stewardship, publication standards, and career pathways.

Advisory Board Member

University of Colorado Denver | May 2014 - Present

Strategic guidance on AI/ML curriculum development and industry partnerships.

Selected Publications and Research

Supply-Chain Disruption, Supplier-Country Health, and the Reallocation of US Import-Value Shares - *Economies* (MDPI), 2026. From Gatekeepers to Launchpads: How Autonomous Governance Transforms Enterprise Architecture - *Metis / IASA Global*, 2026. The Engineering Imperative: Why AI Will Not Replace Your Best Developers - *CIO.com*, 2025. From Fixed Frameworks to Strategic Enablers: Architecting AI Transformation - *CIO.com*, 2025. Cross-Document Emotion Consistency Framework for Financial Disclosure Risk Screening - *Journal of Risk and Financial Management*, 2026. US Patent 10,970,112 B2.